

Your First 30 Days Running a Moving Company: A Week-by-Week Playbook

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Your First 30 Days Running a Moving Company: A Week-by-Week Playbook

The patterns you build in the first 30 days tend to stick. Operators who use this period well build a foundation that compounds for years. Those who drift through it end up spending 12 months fixing habits that should have been right from the start.

Before Day 1: Non-Negotiables

Don't start taking jobs until these are in place:

- ☐ LLC formed, business bank account open
- ☐ Commercial auto insurance bound
- ☐ Cargo liability insurance bound

- ☐ DOT number obtained (free at [fmcsa.dot.gov](https://www.fmcsa.dot.gov))
- ☐ State carrier permit (if required in your state)
- ☐ Truck inspected and operational
- ☐ Equipment on the truck: blankets, dollies, straps, stretch wrap, toolkit
- ☐ Google Business Profile created with basic info
- ☐ Website live with: service area, move types, pricing range, phone number, contact form
- ☐ Rate card defined (know your rates cold before any customer asks)
- ☐ Booking confirmation template ready
- ☐ Review request text template ready

Week 1: First Jobs and First Lessons

Days 1 to 2: Warm outreach. Text or call everyone in your network who might move or know someone moving. Not asking for a favor — informing them that you're open for business and would love to earn their business.

"Hey — I just launched a moving company in [area]. If you or anyone you know is moving in the next few months, I'd love to be your first call. Here's my number."

Days 3 to 5: Realtor outreach. Identify 5 real estate agents in your service area. Call them directly. Introduce yourself, explain your service area and what makes you different, and offer to handle their next client's move at a discounted rate to earn the relationship.

"I'm a local mover just getting started in [area]. I'd love to do one of your clients' moves at a no-profit rate — just to show you how we operate. I want to earn a spot as your go-to referral."

Days 6 to 7: Review your first jobs. What went smoothly? What took longer than expected? Where did communication break down? Write it down. Week 1 is education — pay attention.

Week 1 tracking metrics: Jobs completed, source of each job, move duration vs. estimate, any issues or claims, gross margin per job.

Week 2: Build the Digital Foundation

You can take jobs in week 2. But your primary focus shifts to the assets that will generate inbound jobs for years.

Google Business Profile optimization (3 to 4 hours):

- Add 8 to 12 photos: truck exterior, truck interior with equipment, crew in uniform, an in-progress job shot, logo
- Write a compelling 250 to 300-word description covering: service area, move types, what makes you different, your commitment to care
- Add every service you offer explicitly
- Set precise service area boundaries

Review generation (ongoing from now):

Text every job-1 customer within 24 hours of move completion:

"Hey [Name], it was great helping with your move today! If you had a good experience, a quick Google review would help us grow — here's a direct link: [URL]. Takes about 2 minutes. Thanks!"

Target: 3 to 5 reviews by end of week 2.

Week 2 tracking metrics: Google Business Profile views (check the dashboard), incoming calls (how many from Google vs. referral), review count.

Week 3: Operational Systems

By week 3, you should have your first patterns forming. Use this week to turn those patterns into repeatable systems.

Build your job checklist: A physical or digital checklist for every move. This prevents the errors that generate claims and bad reviews.

Pre-move: confirm address, parking situation, any specialty items, elevator or stairs, access restrictions.

Move day: check truck equipment, brief crew, protect door frames and floors, take photos of fragile items before moving.

Post-move: walk-through with customer, note any pre-existing damage, confirm payment, send review request.

Build your communication templates:

- Booking confirmation (send immediately after booking)
- Day-before reminder (send night before the move)
- Move-day ETA text (send when 30 minutes out)
- Post-move review request (send within 24 hours)

These templates take 2 hours to build and save time on every job going forward. More importantly, they make your communication more consistent — and consistency builds trust.

Expand realtor outreach: 5 more realtors this week. Your target over the first 90 days: 15 to 20 realtor conversations, 3 to 5 ongoing relationships.

Week 3 metrics: Jobs per source, average move duration vs. estimate, review count, realtor relationships initiated.

Week 4: Add a Paid Demand Channel

By week 4, your foundation is solid enough to add paid volume without wasting it.

Option A: Google Local Service Ads

The "Google Guaranteed" listings that appear above regular search results. You pay per verified lead (not per click). Cost: \$20 to \$70 per lead. Close rate: typically 25 to 40%.

Requires a background check and insurance verification to qualify. The Google Guaranteed badge significantly improves conversion rate for customers comparing options.

Option B: Pay-Per-Move

Zero upfront cost. Zero risk. Jobs start within days of activation. For operators who want volume without ad management, this is the lower-friction starting point.

Week 4 metrics: Cost per acquired job by channel, conversion rate (inquiries to booked jobs), jobs per week trend.

End of Month 1: Where You Should Be

Metric	Target
Total jobs completed	12 to 20
Google reviews	5 to 10
Realtor relationships initiated	5 to 10
Active realtor relationships	1 to 3
Monthly revenue	\$8,000 to \$18,000
Utilization rate	40 to 65%
At least 1 paid demand channel active	Yes

The Habit That Matters Most

After every single job: send the review request. Not sometimes. Not when you remember. Every time, within 24 hours.

Operators who build this habit in month 1 have 50+ reviews by year 2. Operators who don't have 8 reviews 3 years later.

The compounding effect of reviews is the most powerful long-term asset in this business. Build the habit now.

Ready to start getting booked before you finish setting up? Book a free strategy call.